



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times
LAPD CHIEF Jim McDonnell, center, says the Police Department must “restore pride within the profession.”

The road to surgeon general is paved with good intentions

On Oct. 29, 2022, the universe told Dr. Casey Means her fate lay in Los Angeles.

President Trump’s new pick for surgeon general wrote in her popular online newsletter of her epiphany, which came during a dawn hike among the cadmium-colored California oaks and flames of wild mustard flower painting the Topanga Canyon: “You must move to L.A. This is where your partner is!”

How Trump nominee met L.A. influencers shaping the ‘Make America Healthy Again’ movement

By Sonja Sharp

Los Angeles has been a Shangri-La for health-seekers since its Gold Rush days as the sanitarium capital of the United States.

Today, it’s the epicenter of America’s \$480-billion wellness industry, where gym-fluencers, plant-medicine gurus and celebrity physicians trade health secrets and discount codes across their blue-check Instagram pages and chart-topping [See MAHA, A9]

Five years after Floyd protests, L.A. paying for police tactics

Use of projectiles at 2020 rallies has cost \$11.9 million in awards and settlements and remains controversial.

By LIBOR JANY

As mass protests over the police murder of George Floyd raged across Los Angeles in late May 2020, the LAPD had an unexpected problem.

After a week of demonstrations, officers had fired so many “less-lethal” crowd control projectiles made of rubber that the department’s stockpile was running low.

Scrambling to buy more, officials arranged for two reserve officers to fly a private plane to Casper, Wyo., to pick up 2,000 additional rounds from an arms wholesaler called Safariland, according to LAPD emails reviewed by The Times.

The days and weeks that followed brought more unrest in the streets, with police criticized for indiscriminately firing rubber rounds into crowds, injuring scores of people with shots to the face or torso.

Multiple reports and ac-

tivists assailed the department’s response to the protests as a botched operation that resulted from poor planning, inadequate training and failure to learn from past mistakes.

According to The Times’ analysis of LAPD data released by the L.A. city attorney’s office, police actions related to the George Floyd protests have cost \$11.9 million in settlements and jury awards. Scores of other pending lawsuits represent potentially tens of millions more in liability exposure.

Yet five years removed from Floyd’s killing, police backers say public opinion has largely swung back in favor of aggressive law enforcement, pointing as proof to last year’s passage of tough-on-crime legislation and ousting of progressive prosecutors.

Last month, President Trump issued an executive order promising to “unleash high-impact local police forces” in his administration’s campaign against “criminal aliens.”

The U.S. Department of Justice moved last week to cancel settlements to overhaul police departments in Louisville, Ky., and Minneapolis. The federal oversight was part of the national [See LAPD, A13]

Immigrants are arrested after cases dismissed

By MELISSA GOMEZ AND RACHEL URANGA

The man just had his immigration case dismissed and his wife and 8-year-old son were trailing behind him when agents surrounded and then handcuffed him outside the downtown Los Angeles courtroom.

Erick Eduardo Fonseca Solorzano stood speechless. His wife trembled in panic. The federal agents explained in Spanish that he would be put into expedited removal proceedings.

Just moments earlier on Friday, Judge Peter A. Kim had issued a dismissal of his deportation case. Now his son watched in wide-eyed disbelief as agents quickly shuffled him to a service elevator — and he was gone. The boy was silent, sticking close by his mother, tears welling.

“This kid will be traumatized for life,” said Lindsay Toczylowski, chief executive and co-founder of Immigrant Defenders Law Center, who reached out to the family to help them with [See Arrests, A10]



CARLIN STIEHL Los Angeles Times
A CHILD whose father was detained by ICE after a hearing in an immigration court in L.A. on Friday.



PATRICK BURKHART
THE YOSEMITE Post Office is turning 100 amid a challenging period.

Yosemite’s longtime lifeline

The remote post office building has connected the park to the outside world for 100 years

By HAILEY BRANSON-POTTS

The letter from Yosemite Postmaster Fred C. Alexander, dated June 29, 1926, was meant to set the record straight regarding a shipment of 50 pounds of frankfurters from San Francisco.

The sausages were to have passed through the newly built Yosemite National Park post office before being delivered to a beloved Yosemite Valley

restaurateur. Alas, the hot dogs didn’t fare so well.

A U.S. Postal Service truck had slid 50 feet down an embankment, and the “box containing the frankfurters was bursted open and the contents strewn considerably,” Alexander wrote to a U.S. Postal Service official in San Francisco.

[See Yosemite, A10]

Cuts spur warning of soaring HIV rates

Coalition says loss of federal funds would affect nation and hit California the hardest.

By KEVIN RECTOR AND SUSANNE RUST

A growing coalition of HIV prevention organizations, health experts and Democrats in Congress are sounding the alarm over sweeping Trump administration cuts to HIV/AIDS prevention and surveillance programs nationally, warning they will reverse years of progress combating the disease and cause spikes in new cases — especially in California and among the LGBTQ+ community.

In a letter Friday addressed to Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., Rep. Laura Friedman (D-Glen-dale) and 22 House colleagues demanded the release of HIV funding allocated by Congress but withheld by the Trump administration. They cited estimates from the Foundation for AIDS Research, known as amfAR, that the cuts could lead to 143,000 additional HIV infections nationwide and 127,000 additional deaths from AIDS-related causes within five years.

Friedman said that the effects would be felt in communities small and large across the country but that [See HIV, A9]

Villaraigosa says bring on Harris

He says she personifies a party that’s lost its way, writes Mark Barabak. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

How AI could change shopping

Tech companies and payment services are doubling down, but it’s still early. **BUSINESS, A15**

Toxic risk in fire cleanup

Day laborers in Altadena often lack protective gear, study finds. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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